DIY AI Workflow Audit Kit

Find out which of your workflows are worth handing to AI, which are a waste of time to automate, and what your team should do in the next 30 days. This is the same method used in the paid AI Workflow Audit, set up for you to run yourself.

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

You need about 90 minutes, one or two people who actually do the work, and this document. Work through the four steps in order. Each one feeds the next.

Step	What you do	Time
1. Interview yourself	Answer seven questions about where your team's time really goes	20 min
2. Map your workflows	Write down three to five candidate workflows, one row each	20 min
3. Score each workflow	Rate repetitiveness, volume and text intensity, then multiply	15 min
4. Write your AI Reality Check	Fill in the report skeleton: summary, gaps, quick wins, next steps	35 min

When you finish, you have a short report you can hand to leadership: a score for each workflow, the gaps holding you back, three quick wins you can start this month with the tools you already pay for, and one AI investment to stop.

> **Be honest, not flattering.** The method only works if you write down what is actually broken, not what looks good on paper. A workflow that scores low is a useful result: it saves you from automating the wrong thing.

If you get stuck or want a second pair of eyes, the price of this kit is credited in full against the audit. Book the fit call: cal.com/este-val/audit-fit-call.

STEP 1: INTERVIEW YOURSELF

Sit down with whoever does the work day to day. Read each question out loud and write the first true answer, not the polished one. These are guardrails, not a script: if an answer opens up something more useful, follow it.

1. Walk through a typical day. What takes the most time?

2. Where has your team already tried using AI? What happened?

3. What is the one report or deliverable that everyone complains about?

4. If you could eliminate one repetitive task this week, what would it be?

5. Does anyone on your team use AI tools that IT does not know about, with work data?

6. What does your current reporting stack look like? How many tools?

7. When leadership asks "what is our AI ROI?", what do you say?

Follow-up questions for every workflow you named

- How many times does that process run per day or per week?
- How many people touch that workflow?
- What is the output format: spreadsheet, email, dashboard, document?
- What would break if that process stopped working tomorrow?

Signs you have a strong candidate for AI

- You cannot name a specific outcome your current AI tools have produced.
- You named three or more disconnected tools in one breath.
- The same data gets entered in more than one place.
- Someone on your team "built something in ChatGPT" that others now depend on.

If two or more of these are true, keep going. You almost certainly have at least one workflow worth fixing.

STEP 2: MAP YOUR WORKFLOWS

Pick three to five workflows from your answers in Step 1. Fill one row per workflow. Use real numbers where you have them and honest estimates where you do not.

#	Process name	Steps	Time per run	Runs per week	People involved	Current AI status	Pain (1 to 5)
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							

Current AI status: pick one

- **Absent:** no AI involved at all.
- **Bolted-on:** AI added on top of the workflow, but not integrated into it.
- **Native:** AI built into the tool your team already uses.
- **Shadow:** your team uses AI tools that have not been approved.

Tips for a useful map

- Name the process the way your team names it, so the report makes sense to them.
- "Steps" means the handoffs: who touches it, in what order. Three to six steps is typical.
- Time per run is the hands-on time for one pass, not the elapsed time while it waits in someone's inbox.
- If a workflow is marked **Shadow**, also note it under Risk Flags in Step 4.

STEP 3: SCORE EACH WORKFLOW

Score every workflow from Step 2 on three factors, from 1 to 5, using the guide below. Then multiply the three scores together. The result is your AI Readiness Score, out of 125.

AI Readiness Score = Repetitiveness x Volume x Text Intensity

Process	Repetitiveness (1 to 5)	Volume (1 to 5)	Text intensity (1 to 5)	AI Readiness Score	Tier
				/125	High / Moderate / Skip
				/125	High / Moderate / Skip
				/125	High / Moderate / Skip
				/125	High / Moderate / Skip
				/125	High / Moderate / Skip

Scoring guide

Score	Repetitiveness: how often it runs	Volume: items per run	Text intensity: how much is free text
5	Daily	100 or more per day	Full documents
4	Several times a week	10 to 99 per day	Summaries and reports
3	Weekly	1 to 9 per day	Structured data plus text
2	Every two weeks	Several per week	Semi-structured
1	Monthly	Fewer than 5 per week	Pure forms

Read your tier

Score	Tier	What it means for you
60 or more	High	Fast return. Prioritize this workflow.
30 to 59	Moderate	A good candidate, with a person reviewing the AI's output before it goes anywhere.
Below 30	Skip	Not an AI problem. Fix the process first: simplify it, remove a step, or stop doing it.

Worked example

Your accounts team matches supplier invoices against purchase orders every day (Repetitiveness 5). They handle about 40 a day (Volume 4). Each invoice is a PDF with line items and notes (Text intensity 3). The score is 5 x 4 x 3 = **60, High**. That is a workflow to put at the top of your report.

Compare a monthly board summary: it runs once a month (1), produces one document (1), and is all free text (5). The score is 1 x 1 x 5 = **5, Skip**. It may be painful, but it is not where AI pays back first.

STEP 4: WRITE YOUR AI REALITY CHECK

This is your report. Write it for a non-technical executive who reads only the first section. Keep each section short and specific: generic findings like "better data culture" are not actionable. Name the workflow, the goal and what is missing.

Executive Summary

In two or three sentences: what is the single most important finding, and what is the one thing your team should do in the next 30 days?

Overall AI Readiness: ____ / 10

Category	Your rating	One-line signal
Workflow automation potential	/10	
Data quality (is your data ready for AI?)	/10	
AI and LLM cost efficiency	/10	
Unapproved AI tool use	Low / Medium / High	
Compliance and risk posture	Low / Medium / High	

Bottom line (one sentence). For example: "3 of 5 workflows we reviewed have genuine AI potential; the highest-value one is [workflow] at an estimated $[X] a year."

Current AI Stack

List every AI tool your team uses, including the ones paid for on personal cards and expensed.

Tool	Department	Use case	Monthly cost	Status
				Active / Underused / Unknown
				Active / Underused / Unknown
				Active / Underused / Unknown
				Active / Underused / Unknown

Total tracked AI spend: $_____ a month, $_____ a year.

What is working: tools or workflows producing a result you can measure.

What is not: tools or workflows with active spend and nothing measurable to show for it.

Gap Analysis

The gaps between how you use AI today and what the business is trying to achieve. One column per gap; three is plenty.

	Gap 1	Gap 2	Gap 3
Gap name			
Workflow affected			
Business goal			
Current state			
Root cause			
Impact if unresolved			

Root cause, pick one: data quality, wrong tool, process problem, missing automation, or relying on AI for a task that needs human judgment. **Impact:** put a number on it where you can, in hours a week, error rate or cost.

Quick Wins: your 30-day roadmap

Actions your team can finish with the tools you already have, no new budget and no developer. If a win needs a developer, it belongs in the next section.

	Win 1	Win 2	Win 3
Title			
What to do			
Where (tool or workflow)			
How long it takes			
Expected result			
Who owns it (role, not name)			

"How long it takes" means setup hours plus minutes a week to keep it running. "Expected result" should be measurable: hours saved, errors reduced, or cost avoided.

Strategic Recommendations: your 90-day plan

Actions that need new tooling, implementation time or budget. Make a build or buy call for each one.

	Recommendation 1	Recommendation 2	Recommendation 3
Title			
Priority (High / Medium / Low)			
Effort to implement			
Cost (one-time plus monthly)			
ROI projection			
Payback period			
Build or buy			
Dependencies			
First action			

ROI projection: hours saved a week x loaded hourly rate, or error rate reduction x cost per error. **Dependencies:** what has to be true before you start, such as data cleanup, headcount or a process change.

Who does what: human in the loop

For every recommendation, decide where the AI stops and a person takes over. Write this down before you build anything.

Opportunity	AI does	Your team does	Handoff point (where a person reviews)

Risk Flags

Blockers. An unresolved risk flag will undermine any AI investment, so deal with these before you expand. Any workflow you marked **Shadow** in Step 2 belongs here.

	Flag 1	Flag 2
Title		
Severity (Critical / High / Medium)		
Risk: what could go wrong		
Current exposure		
Trigger: what makes it a live problem		
Recommended action		
Address within		

Pay special attention to personal or financial data going into AI tools your company has not approved. That is the most common flag, and the easiest to miss.

ROI Summary

Opportunity	Type	Annual value	Implementation cost	Payback
Quick Win 1	Time savings	$	$0	Immediate
Quick Win 2	Error reduction	$	$0	Immediate
Recommendation 1	Automation	$ a year	$	months
Recommendation 2	Cost avoidance	$ a year	$	months
Total identified value		**$ a year**	**$**	

How to calculate annual value: hours saved a week x blended hourly rate x 52. If you do not know your rate, use 50 to 75 dollars an hour for operations roles and 75 to 100 for technical roles. **Payback period:** implementation cost divided by weekly savings, in weeks.

What to stop: name one AI investment to cut, and the annual savings from cancelling it.

Next Steps

Based on your findings, which path are you on? Circle one.

Path 1: Fix it yourself. Your quick wins cover the highest-value opportunities. You do not need outside help. Write down how many hours it will take, over how many weeks, and the value you expect to recover in a year.

Path 2: Clean up the data first. One or more of your best workflows cannot be automated until the data underneath it is structured. That is not an AI problem, it is a data quality problem, and it has to be solved first. Write down which workflow and roughly how much cleanup it needs. If you want help scoping it, book the fit call.

Path 3: Get implementation support. Your recommendations need someone to build, test and keep them calibrated as your AI stack grows. Most teams stall between the findings and the first working pipeline. If that is you, book the fit call.

WHEN YOU FINISH

- Share the Executive Summary with leadership. If they read only one section, that is the one.
- Start Quick Win 1 this week. Put a date on it.
- Re-score your workflows in 90 days. The scores should move.

Want a second pair of eyes? Bring this completed kit to a fit call and we will go through your scores and gaps together. The price of this kit is credited in full against the audit. Book here: cal.com/este-val/audit-fit-call.